

NKM2 – NKM2 TASK 1: CAPSTONE TOPIC APPROVAL AND RELEASE FORM

DATA ANALYTICS GRADUATE CAPSTONE – D214

PRFA – NKM2

Task Overview

Submissions

Evaluation Report

COMPETENCIES

981.1.1 : Capstone

The graduate integrates and synthesizes competencies from across the degree program and thereby demonstrates the ability to participate in and contribute value to the chosen professional field.

INTRODUCTION

For your capstone, you will identify an original real-data research question and propose a project to address it. In later tasks, you will be asked to gather, analyze, and present data related to your research question.

Your capstone proposal serves the purpose of organizing your ideas for the project so you can complete the project as efficiently as possible. In order to start the capstone project, you must first discuss your project ideas and potential research question with a course instructor. After an agreement is reached, you must fill out the top portion of the attached “MSDA Capstone Topic Approval Form” and send it to the **course instructor**, who must digitally sign it and lock it to prevent further changes in the document. The completed form, signed by the course instructor, must be uploaded together with the other documents required for this task.

It is the policy of Western Governors University (WGU) that student capstone projects should not be based on or include any proprietary or classified information or material belonging to your employer or any other organization unless you obtain the owner’s permission to use it. Such material belongs to this third party and is referred to as “restricted information.” You must declare with a digital signature whether your capstone project is based upon or includes restricted information by submitting the attached “MSDA Capstone Release Form.” This completed attachment also documents that you have permission from the third party to use the restricted information.

Projects involving human subjects or the use of protected data will require IRB approval. Work directly with your course instructor if your project includes research that involves human subjects to determine whether it requires review by WGU’s Institutional Review Board (IRB).

Note: Any information that would be considered confidential, proprietary, or personal in nature should not be included in the actual task submission to WGU. Do not include the actual names of people, suppliers, or companies, or other identifiable information. Fictional names should be used where necessary. Company



specific data, including financial information, should not be included but should be addressed in a general fashion as appropriate.

REQUIREMENTS

Your submission must be your original work. No more than a combined total of 30% of the submission and no more than a 10% match to any one individual source can be directly quoted or closely paraphrased from sources, even if cited correctly. The originality report that is provided when you submit your task can be used as a guide.

You must use the rubric to direct the creation of your submission because it provides detailed criteria that will be used to evaluate your work. Each requirement below may be evaluated by more than one rubric aspect. The rubric aspect titles may contain hyperlinks to relevant portions of the course.

*Tasks may **not** be submitted as cloud links, such as links to Google Docs, Google Slides, OneDrive, etc., unless specified in the task requirements. All other submissions must be file types that are uploaded and submitted as attachments (e.g., .docx, .pdf, .ppt).*

- A. Complete the attached “MSDA Capstone Topic Approval Form,” including a signature and date from your course instructor to indicate that this form has been approved.
- B. Complete the attached “MSDA Capstone Release Form” and digitally sign it where applicable, after choosing the option that applies to your capstone project.

Note: More than one signature is required.

- C. Acknowledge sources, using in-text citations and references, for content that is quoted, paraphrased, or summarized.
- D. Demonstrate professional communication in the content and presentation of your submission.

File Restrictions

File name may contain only letters, numbers, spaces, and these symbols: ! - _ . * ' ()

File size limit: 200 MB

File types allowed: doc, docx, rtf, xls, xlsx, ppt, pptx, odt, pdf, csv, txt, qt, mov, mpg, avi, mp3, wav, mp4, wma, flv, asf, mpeg, wmv, m4v, svg, tif, tiff, jpeg, jpg, gif, png, zip, rar, tar, 7z

RUBRIC

A: TOPIC APPROVAL FORM

NOT EVIDENT

The “MSDA Capstone Topic Approval Form” is not submitted.

APPROACHING COMPETENCE

The “MSDA Capstone Topic Approval Form” is incomplete or does not include the signature

COMPETENT

The completed “MSDA Capstone Topic Approval Form” is complete, including the signature and

or date from the course instructor. Or the proposed solution is not original.

date from the course instructor.
The proposed solution is original.

B:CAPSTONE RELEASE FORM

NOT EVIDENT

The “MSDA Capstone Release Form” is not submitted.

APPROACHING COMPETENCE

The “MSDA Capstone Release Form” is incomplete or missing 1 or more needed signatures.

COMPETENT

The completed “MSDA Capstone Release Form” is submitted and includes *all* needed signatures.

C:SOURCES

NOT EVIDENT

The submission does not include both in-text citations and a reference list for sources that are quoted, paraphrased, or summarized.

APPROACHING COMPETENCE

The submission includes in-text citations for sources that are quoted, paraphrased, or summarized and a reference list; however, the citations or reference list is incomplete or inaccurate.

COMPETENT

The submission includes in-text citations for sources that are properly quoted, paraphrased, or summarized and a reference list that accurately identifies the author, date, title, and source location as available.

D:PROFESSIONAL COMMUNICATION

NOT EVIDENT

This submission includes professional communication errors related to spelling, grammar, punctuation, and sentence fluency. For best results, please focus on the specific Correctness errors identified by Grammarly for Education to help guide your revisions. If you need additional assistance preparing your submission, please contact your Instructor.

APPROACHING COMPETENCE

This submission includes professional communication errors related to spelling, grammar, punctuation, and/or sentence fluency. For best results, please focus on the specific Correctness errors identified by Grammarly for Education to help guide your revisions.

COMPETENT

This submission demonstrates correct use of spelling, grammar, punctuation, and sentence fluency. You have demonstrated quality professional communication skills in this submission.

SUPPORTING DOCUMENTS

[MSDA Capstone Release Form.docx](#)

[MSDA Capstone Topic Approval Form.docx](#)